Padshah, ‘making loyalty more profitable than rebellion’, according to historian Rima Hooja. The kingdoms of Rajasthan slowly became more peaceful, as Akbar condemned and discouraged the wars between states for expansionist purposes. The jagirs that the Rajput chieftains were awarded usually included the assessed revenue of their ancestral lands, the watan jagirs, while Akbar maintained the right to confirm each successive ruler in his domain. This granting of the coronation teeka by the Mughal Padshah was a powerful symbol, fracturing some of the old clan structures between the rulers and their clansmen. One of the famous instances of the Padshah confirming a besieged contender to rule was for his favourite, ‘Mota Raja’ Udai Singh of Marwar. Most of the time, however, Akbar rarely interfered in the Rajput succession process, the Mughal Empire profiting from the symbiotic relationship of the chieftains with their clansmen, who could raise strong armies from among their kinsmen. A great many Rajput chieftains would not only have exemplary careers, travelling the length and breadth of Hindustan, and thereby changing the very topography and culture of their home states, but would forge deep personal bonds of friendship with Akbar.

The administration of the kingdoms of Rajasthan would be profoundly influenced by their incorporation into the Mughal Empire. In Marwar, Raja Udai Singh was assisted in this task by his pradhan, or adviser, one Govind Das Bhati, ‘who was fully conversant with Akbar’s administrative system’. The office of diwan was instituted, and it was usually held by a member of the elite Mutsaddie group, from the Oswal Jain business community, and the diwan gradually became the most powerful officer of the state. There were also bakshis, or military commanders, kotwals, and a wakil, who was the state’s representative at the Mughal court with the force of the Mughal Padshah behind him.

Another state which was transformed by its alliance with the Mughal Padshah was Bikaner. Bikaner had been peacefully incorporated into the empire, and a daughter of Raja Kalyanmal had married Akbar. Kalyanmal’s son, Kuar Rai Singh, then proved his courage in battle during the Gujarat wars and when Mughal authority was resisted by Marwar’s Rao Chandrasen and Mewar’s Rana Pratap, Akbar assigned the administration of Jodhpur to Rai Singh. During the three years that Jodhpur remained under Rai Singh, ‘various villages were endowed to Brahmans, Charans, and Bhats’. Upon the death of his father in 1574, Rai Singh was the first ruler of Bikaner to be